THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

Impact Measurement Framework

Building Whole Communities, One Life at a Time.

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Executive Summary

The Impact Measurement Framework establishes how The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF) assesses the long-term effects of its programmes, partnerships and institutional investments.

While monitoring focuses on implementation and outputs, and evaluation examines programme performance, impact measurement seeks to understand whether the Foundation's interventions contribute to sustainable improvements in people's lives, stronger institutions and more resilient communities.

This Framework provides a consistent approach to defining, measuring and communicating impact across all programme areas.

Purpose

The Framework aims to:

- Measure long-term change.
- Assess contribution to sustainable development.
- Strengthen evidence-based decision-making.
- Improve programme effectiveness.
- Demonstrate accountability to stakeholders.
- Support organizational learning.
- Enhance donor confidence.
- Inform strategic planning.

Scope

This Framework applies to:

- Multi-year programmes.
- Strategic initiatives.
- Institutional capacity-building programmes.
- Community development projects.
- Pilot initiatives that may be scaled.
- Programmes requiring long-term outcome assessment.

Not every project requires a full impact evaluation; the scale and approach should be proportionate to the programme.

Definition of Impact

For the Foundation, **impact** refers to:

> **Sustained positive changes in individuals, households, communities, institutions or systems that can reasonably be associated with the Foundation's interventions and partnerships.**

Impact may be:

- Social
- Economic
- Environmental
- Institutional
- Behavioural
- Policy-related

Guiding Principles

Impact measurement should be:

- Mission-aligned.
- Evidence-based.
- Ethical.
- Participatory.
- Inclusive.
- Transparent.
- Proportionate.
- Focused on learning as well as accountability.

Impact Pathway

```
Inputs
    |
    ▼
Activities
    |
    ▼
Outputs
    |
    ▼
Short-Term Outcomes
    |
    ▼
Intermediate Outcomes
    |
    ▼
Long-Term Impact
```

The Foundation recognizes that impact is often influenced by external factors and contributions from other actors.

Domains of Impact

The Foundation measures impact across several strategic domains.

Education

Illustrative impact areas:

- Increased educational attainment.
- Improved employability.
- Lifelong learning.
- Greater digital literacy.

Sample indicators:

- Percentage of graduates employed within 12 months.
- Improvement in literacy or competency scores.
- Retention in education or training.

Health

Illustrative impact areas:

- Improved health outcomes.
- Reduced preventable illness.
- Increased health-seeking behaviour.
- Better maternal and child wellbeing.

Sample indicators:

- Sustained adoption of healthy practices.
- Reduction in preventable disease incidence.
- Improved access to essential health services.

Sustainable Livelihoods

Illustrative impact areas:

- Increased household income.
- Greater financial resilience.
- Enterprise growth.
- Employment creation.

Sample indicators:

- Median household income change.
- Business survival after two years.
- Household savings growth.

Environment

Illustrative impact areas:

- Improved ecosystem resilience.
- Sustainable natural resource management.
- Climate adaptation.
- Reduced environmental degradation.

Sample indicators:

- Survival rate of planted trees after three years.
- Area of land restored.
- Adoption of climate-smart practices.

Institutional Strengthening

Illustrative impact areas:

- Improved governance.
- Enhanced organizational performance.
- Stronger partnerships.
- Better service delivery.

Sample indicators:

- Governance compliance scores.
- Timeliness of reporting.
- Partner satisfaction.
- Organizational capacity assessment results.

Measuring Contribution

The Foundation acknowledges that development outcomes are rarely attributable to a single organization.

Impact assessments should therefore consider:

- The Foundation's contribution.
- The role of partners.
- Community participation.
- External influences.
- Contextual changes.

This approach promotes balanced and credible reporting.

Data Sources

Impact measurement may draw upon:

- Baseline studies.
- End-line studies.
- Household surveys.
- Key informant interviews.
- Focus group discussions.
- Administrative data.
- National statistics.
- Independent evaluations.

- Case studies.
- Geographic information systems (GIS).

Where appropriate, mixed-method approaches should be used.

Timing of Impact Measurement

Impact should be assessed at intervals appropriate to the nature of the programme.

Typical approaches include:

Timing	Purpose
Baseline	Establish starting conditions
Mid-term	Assess progress and adjust implementation
End-line	Measure achievement at project completion
Post-project	Assess sustainability after completion

Longer-term follow-up studies may be undertaken where resources permit.

Learning from Impact

Impact findings should be used to:

- Improve programme design.
- Inform strategic planning.
- Refine the Theory of Change.
- Update indicators.
- Share lessons with stakeholders.
- Strengthen future proposals.

Learning is a primary objective of impact measurement.

Ethical Considerations

Impact measurement shall:

- Respect participant dignity.
- Protect confidential information.
- Obtain informed consent where required.
- Minimize burden on participants.
- Ensure inclusion of marginalized groups.
- Avoid overstating or misrepresenting findings.

Reporting

Impact reports should include:

- Purpose and scope.
- Methodology.
- Key findings.
- Evidence and analysis.
- Limitations.

- Lessons learned.
- Recommendations.
- Management response (where appropriate).

Reports should distinguish clearly between measured results, observed outcomes and reasonable contributions.

Continuous Improvement

The Foundation will strengthen its impact measurement system by:

- Investing in staff capacity.
- Improving data systems.
- Adopting appropriate digital technologies.
- Incorporating stakeholder feedback.
- Periodically reviewing methodologies.
- Learning from external good practice.

Review

This Framework shall be reviewed every two years or earlier if organizational priorities, programme models or donor expectations change.

> **True impact is measured not only by what we do, but by the lasting improvements communities experience long after our direct involvement has ended.**